ORDER 7110.13A

Effective Date:
March 20, 2026

SUBJ: SUN FCT Standard Operating Procedures

This document establishes the Hailey/Sun Valley/Friedman Memorial Airport Federal Contract Control Tower (SUN FCT) Standard Operating Procedures within the Salt Lake City ARTCC on VATSIM (vZLC). Controllers are required to be familiar with the provisions of this document and to exercise their best judgment if they encounter situations not covered by it. The provisions and procedures described herein are supplemental to vZLC Facility Policy and FAA Order JO 7110.65.

The information contained herein is to be used for flight simulation purposes only on the VATSIM network. It is not intended, nor should it be used for real-world navigation. The Virtual Salt Lake City ARTCC is not affiliated with the FAA, the actual Salt Lake City ARTCC, or any governing aviation body.

Cameron Negrete
Air Traffic Manager
Salt Lake City ARTCC

Adam Earl
Facilities Engineer
Salt Lake City ARTCC

Record of Changes

Version	Description	Effective Date	Issued By
7110.13A	Initial Release In New Format	Mar 20, 2026	AE

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Chapter 1. Standard Operating Control Procedures

Section 1. Introduction

1-1-1. Purpose
This document establishes the Hailey/Sun Valley/Friedman Memorial Airport Federal Contract Control Tower (SUN FCT) Standard Operating Procedures within the Salt Lake City ARTCC on VATSIM (vZLC).

1-1-2. Audience
All vZLC controllers and visitors contained within the vZLC and VATUSA roster.

1-1-3. Distribution
This document is authorized for unrestricted use and release and is available in the Resources Section of the vZLC Website.

1-1-4. Cancellation
This document cancels the SUN FD, effective August 6, 2025.

1-1-5. Special Information About Hailey Airport

a. Friedman Memorial Airport is located in the Rocky Mountains of south central Idaho. The airport is in a narrow valley, just north of a large plain. It is surrounded by high terrain with the highest mountains to the north. The Smoky Mountain Range is to the west, and the Pioneer Mountain Range is to the east. Magic Reservoir is near the Big Wood River Valley entrance, 12 NM to the southwest. To the east-northeast, terrain rises to 8324 feet MSL within 3 NM. To the west, Kelly Mountain rises to 8856 feet MSL within 7 NM.
b. The higher landing minimums and special missed approach procedures are designed to allow for clearance of high terrain near the airport.
c. Windshear may be encountered, especially during periods of high wind conditions along with the use of runways not based on winds but normalcy.

Section 2. Operational Positions

Table 1-2-1. SUN FCT Operational Positions Table

Sector/Position	STARS ID	VATSIM Callsign	Frequency
Ground Control (GC)	**N/A**	**SUN_GND**	**121.700**
Local Control (LC)	**N/A**	**SUN_TWR**	**125.600**

Bold designates a primary position.

Section 3. Intrafacility Coordination Procedures

1-3-1. Runway Configurations
The active runway configuration refers to the general cardinal direction of departures and arrivals currently in use. Authorized runway configurations are listed in subparagraphs c. and d.

a. When selecting a runway configuration, the following factors must be considered:
   (1) Standard Runway Config
   (2) Terrain And Visibility
   (3) Wind speed. The gust factor takes precedence over the constant wind speed.
b. Runway 31 is the designated landing runway at all times except for times of extreme wind but clear skies to allow for circling approaches (RNAV-Y) or (NDB-B).
c. Runway 13 is the designated departure runway and is to be used at all times, IFR departures off of runway 31 are not authorized at any point in time.

1-3-2. Changing Runway Configurations
The Local Control (LC) position is the final authority for selecting the runway configuration, but coordination with GC and SLC CTR must be accomplished prior to changing the runway configuration.

a. LC must:
   (1) Coordinate with GC to determine which aircraft will be the last departure and arrival in the old runway configuration.
   (2) Ensure that:
      (a) The ATIS is updated to reflect the runway configuration change.
      (b) Runway 31 is not used for IFR departures at any time
      (c) Visibility permits use of Runway 13 for landing if necessary.
   (3) Notify ZLC ARTCC Sectors 31 and 41 (or other appropriate overlying sector) of the runway configuration change.

1-3-3. ATIS
Regardless of the position broadcasting the ATIS, the following statements must be included on the ATIS broadcast:

a. During VFR weather conditions: “DEPARTING VFR AIRCRAFT ADVISE GROUND CONTROL OF REQUESTED HEADING OR DESTINATION.”
b. When the outside air temperature is 26°C or greater: “CHECK DENSITY ALTITUDE.”

   NOTE-
   This statement must be made immediately after stating the altimeter setting.

Section 4. Opposite Direction Operations (ODO)

1-4-1. General
Opposite Direction Operations consist of IFR/VFR operations conducted to the same or parallel runway where an aircraft is operating in a reciprocal direction of another aircraft arriving, departing, or conducting an approach. <u>This is standard practice here at Hailey!</u>

NOTE-
Departing aircraft include aircraft conducting a touch-and-go, stop-and-go, low approach, missed approach, or go-around.

1-4-2. Responsibilities
a. LC is responsible for applying the cutoff point between opposite direction arriving and departing aircraft.
b. SLC CTR (Sector 31) is responsible for applying the cutoff point between opposite direction arrival aircraft.

1-4-3. IFR Aircraft Procedures
a. General:
   (1) Traffic advisories must be issued to all ODO aircraft.

   PHRASEOLOGY-
   OPPOSITE DIRECTION TRAFFIC (distance) MILE FINAL, (type aircraft).
   OPPOSITE DIRECTION TRAFFIC DEPARTING RUNWAY (number), (type aircraft).
   OPPOSITE DIRECTION TRAFFIC (position), (type aircraft).

   (2) VFR aircraft conducting practice approaches may or may not receive IFR services.
   (3) Opposite direction, same or parallel runway, operations with opposing traffic inside the cutoff point are allowed with visual/tower applied separation.
   (4) Lateral separation must exist before any other type of separation is applied.
b. Coordination:
   (1) LC does not need to verbally request opposite direction departures with CTR.
   (2) CTR does not need to verbally request opposite direction arrivals with LC.
c. Cutoff procedures for aircraft conducting ODO to the same runway:
   (1) A departing aircraft must be airborne and have turned to avoid conflict prior to an aircraft reaching:
      (a) A point five flying miles from the threshold of the runway of intended landing or, if an aircraft is established in the traffic pattern, prior to that aircraft turning base leg.
      (b) If the above conditions are not met, action must be taken to ensure control instructions are issued to protect the integrity of the cutoff points.
   (2) An arriving aircraft must cross the runway threshold prior to an aircraft reaching:

(a) A point five flying miles from the threshold of the runway of intended landing or, if an aircraft is established in the traffic pattern, prior to that aircraft turning base leg.
(b) If the above conditions are not met, action must be taken to ensure control instructions are issued to protect the integrity of the cutoff points.

d. Cutoff procedures for aircraft conducting ODO to parallel runways:
   (1) Provide a turn away from the opposing arriving traffic before the arrival is inside of the cutoff point to the other runway. The same cutoff points in subparagraph c. must apply.

NOTE-
1. *Visual separation of any type may be applied after the turn away from opposing traffic is issued.*
2. *Prior to a pilot providing visual separation, a heading with at least 15° angular difference between the aircraft's flight paths must be assigned to ensure flight paths do not cross.*

1-4-4. VFR Aircraft Procedures

a. Ensure VFR aircraft are issued and are aware of traffic to avoid conflict with the opposing IFR/VFR traffic.
b. LC must issue traffic information to both aircraft and indicate the direction that the departure will turn (arrival/departure ODO) or the location of the opposing aircraft on final (arrival/arrival ODO).

Chapter 2. Operational Positions

Section 1. Ground Control (GC)

2-1-1. Position Responsibilities

a. Monitor the GC frequency (121.700 MHz).
b. Prepare, update, and mark flight progress strips in accordance with the ZLC Flight Strip Handling Directive (7210.3).
c. Issue departure clearances to IFR aircraft, complying with posted traffic management initiatives (TMIs), letters of agreement (LOAs), and published preferred routes.
d. Handle VFR departure aircraft in accordance with paragraphs 2-1-4 and 2-1-5.
e. Ensure all taxiing aircraft have the current ATIS.
f. Determine/finalize aircraft departure runway assignments.
g. Assume other ground control or other cab responsibilities, as assigned.

2-1-2. Area of Jurisdiction

GC has jurisdiction of all movement areas except active runways.

2-1-3. IFR Departure Instructions

Departing IFR aircraft must be assigned the following:

a. In All Configs
    i. All RNAV-capable aircraft
        1. Issue FLIYN SID
    ii. All Non-RNAV aircraft:
        1. Issue RWY 13 ODP
        2. A VCOA may be approved when specifically requested by the pilot

b. An initial altitude of 15,000 feet, or lower cruising altitude if compliant with the MOCA.

NOTE-
Departure headings are not authorized, as terrain constraints do not allow for it.

NOTE-
AUREL SID is valid until 3/26/2026, aircraft may use/be assigned this RNAV SID until then.

NOTE-
Every attempt will be made to route all IFR departures on an approved SID appropriate for their route of flight. Aircraft unable/refusing to accept a SID will be assigned Runway 13 ODP.

2-1-4. VFR Departure Instructions

Departing VFR aircraft have the ability to fly the published VFR departure:

a. A pilot may request: WOOD RIVER VISUAL DEP
    i. You are required to abide by this request if operationally safe.

2-1-5. VFR FF Departure Instructions

All VFR aircraft that requested flight following and will depart the Class D surface area must:

a. Be issued both of the following:
    (1) Appropriate departure frequency.
    (2) Discrete beacon code.
b. Have the following filled out:
    (1) Flight Strip, in accordance with the ZLC Flight Strip Handling Directive (7210.3).
    (2) Flight Plan.

NOTE-
Aircraft that depart the Class D surface area and are not requesting flight following are not to have any of the above, except a filled out Half Strip.

2-1-6. VFR Arrival Instructions

SUN Local may change VFR arrival aircraft to runway 13. This is generally done by telling VFR planes to remain over or East of the ridge and to enter a left downwind for Runway 13.

PHRASEOLOGY-
ENTER LEFT DOWN RUNWAY 13. REMAIN OVER OR EAST OF THE RIDGE

2-1-7. Traffic Flow

GC must ensure all aircraft yield to aircraft exiting a runway, unless otherwise coordinated with LC.

2-1-8. ATIS

Ensure all departure aircraft have the current ATIS. If you have the VATIS BETA you're encouraged to use Voice Recorded ATIS mode over the Automated Mode as this airport is not listed as a D-ATIS airport.

2-1-9. Pushback Clearances

All Aircraft are required to receive pushback clearance before pushing back off the terminal onto taxiway B.

Section 2. Local Control (LC)

2-2-1. Position Responsibilities

a. Monitor the LC frequency (125.600 MHz).
b. Provide control instructions to aircraft within the LC area of jurisdiction.
c. Determine the appropriate runway configuration in accordance with paragraph 1-3-1.
d. Sequence and separate departures and arrivals.
e. Mark FPSs in accordance with the ZLC Flight Strip Handling Directive (7210.3).
f. Assume other local control or other cab responsibilities, as assigned.

2-2-2. Area of Jurisdiction

LC has jurisdiction of the following:

a. LC airspace, as depicted in Appendix 1.
b. Runway 13/31

2-2-3. Departures

a. IFR Departure Notification / Releases
    i. A “Release Request” (.RR) is required to be sent to the appropriate Departure Controller for all departing aircraft in accordance with the General Control Directive.
    ii. Release requests may also be verbally coordinated.
b. VFR aircraft to unicom, unless the VFR has requested Flight Following and those go to the appropriate departure frequency.
c. Main Departure Frequency
    i. Salt Lake Center (Sector 31) 118.050.
d. Runway Usage
    i. Runway 13 is the only runway to be used for departures, if the weather doesn’t allow for safe departures on Runway 13 (Example: 30 Knot Winds Out Of The North), aircraft must be held until conditions improve.

2-2-4. Approaches/Arrivals

a. Non-FAA Published Approaches
    i. At Hailey and other smaller airports with complex procedures some airlines and operators pay to have a specific approach made for them with lower minimums, better performance for their aircraft and other reasons. If a pilot requests such an approach, you must get the IAF/IF, FAF and the altitudes for them to allow the aircraft to use the approach.
a. Missed Approach/Go Around
    i. Send a Missed Notification (.MA) for the aircraft executing an unplanned Missed Approach/Go Around to the appropriate Center sector that will be receiving the aircraft for re-sequencing.
    ii. The following is considered a Primary Climb-Out procedure and does not require any special coordination with Center or Strip marking other than the basic Missed Notification. Aircraft must not turn prior to the departure end of the runway.

Handoff/Comm-Change to the appropriate Center sector must be completed no later than 1 mile off the departure end of the runway.

b. Climb Out Procedure:
    i. Fly Published Missed Approach.
    ii. Otherwise Follow The Valley On Heading 320, Climb and Maintain 12,000.

c. VFR traffic joins the local pattern.

2-2-5. Tower Procedures

a. LAHSO.
    i. Not authorized.
b. Tower Use of Radar:
    i. None.

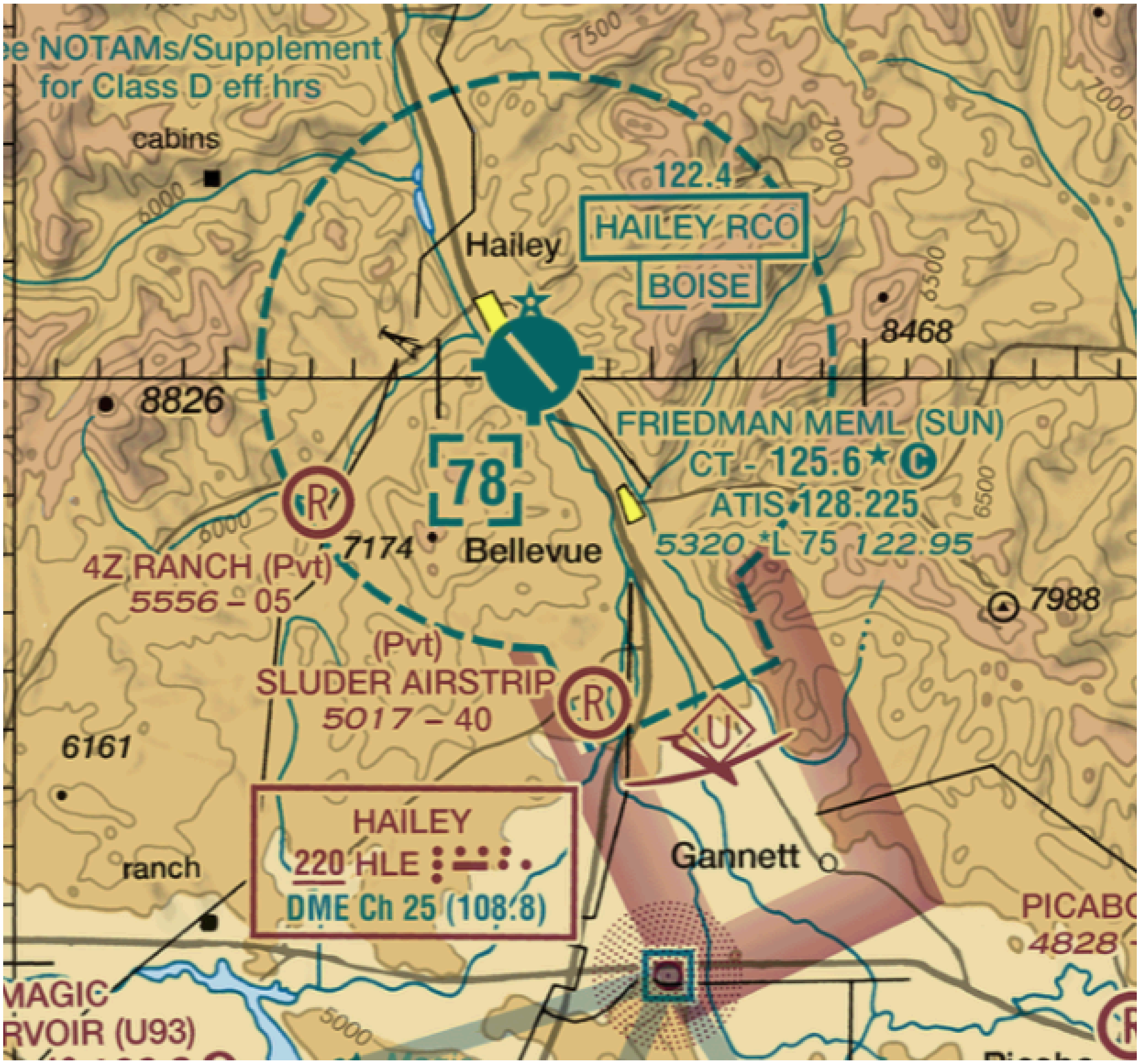
2-2-6. Center Coordination

Salt Lake Center may provide radar traffic calls for Sun Valley Local control and will coordinate them via discord landline. Sun valley tower shall then relay the radar traffic call to the aircraft via the following phraseology.

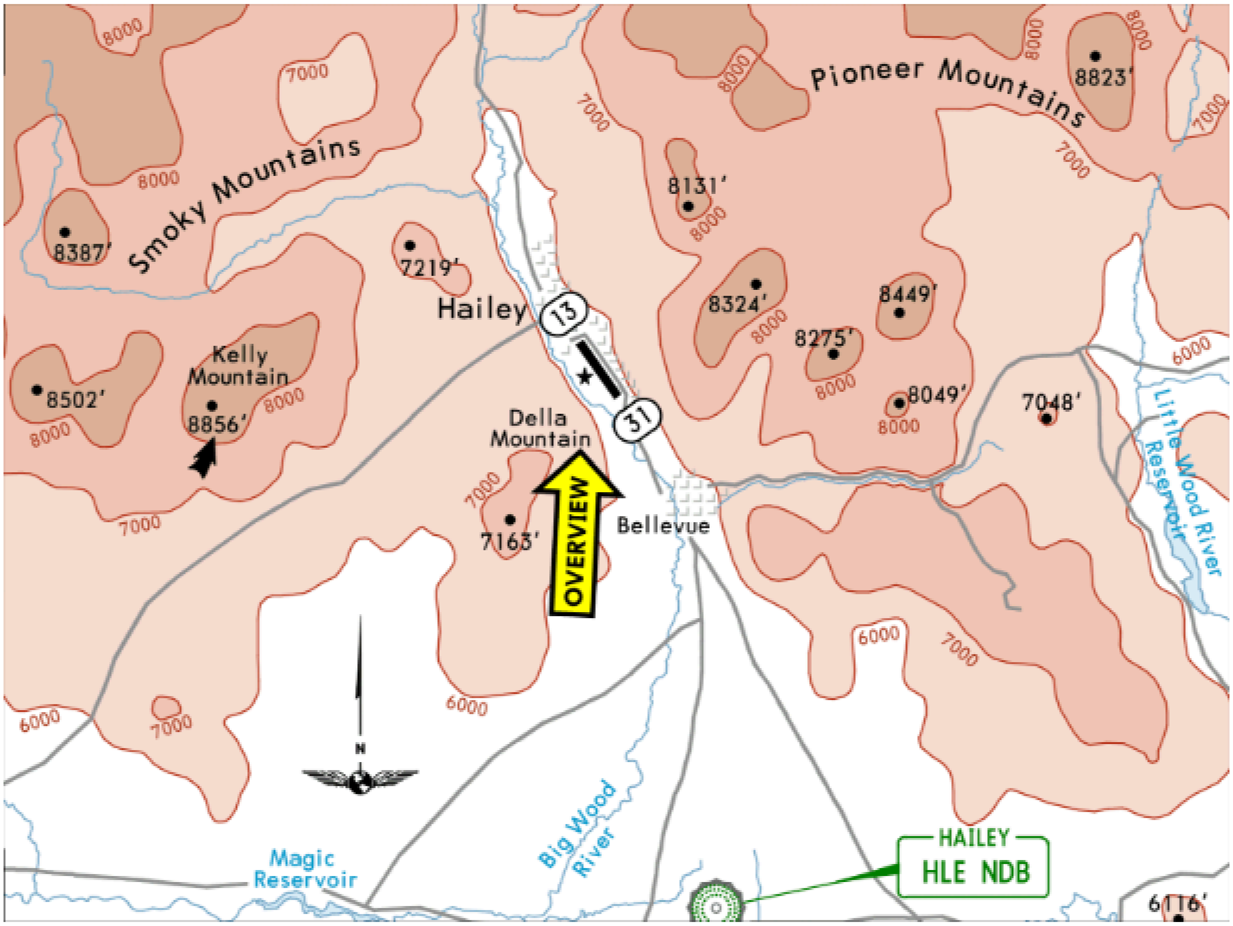
PHRASEOLOGY

"*Salt Lake Center advises traffic is at your <direction> and <distance>....”*

Appendix 1: Tower Airspace



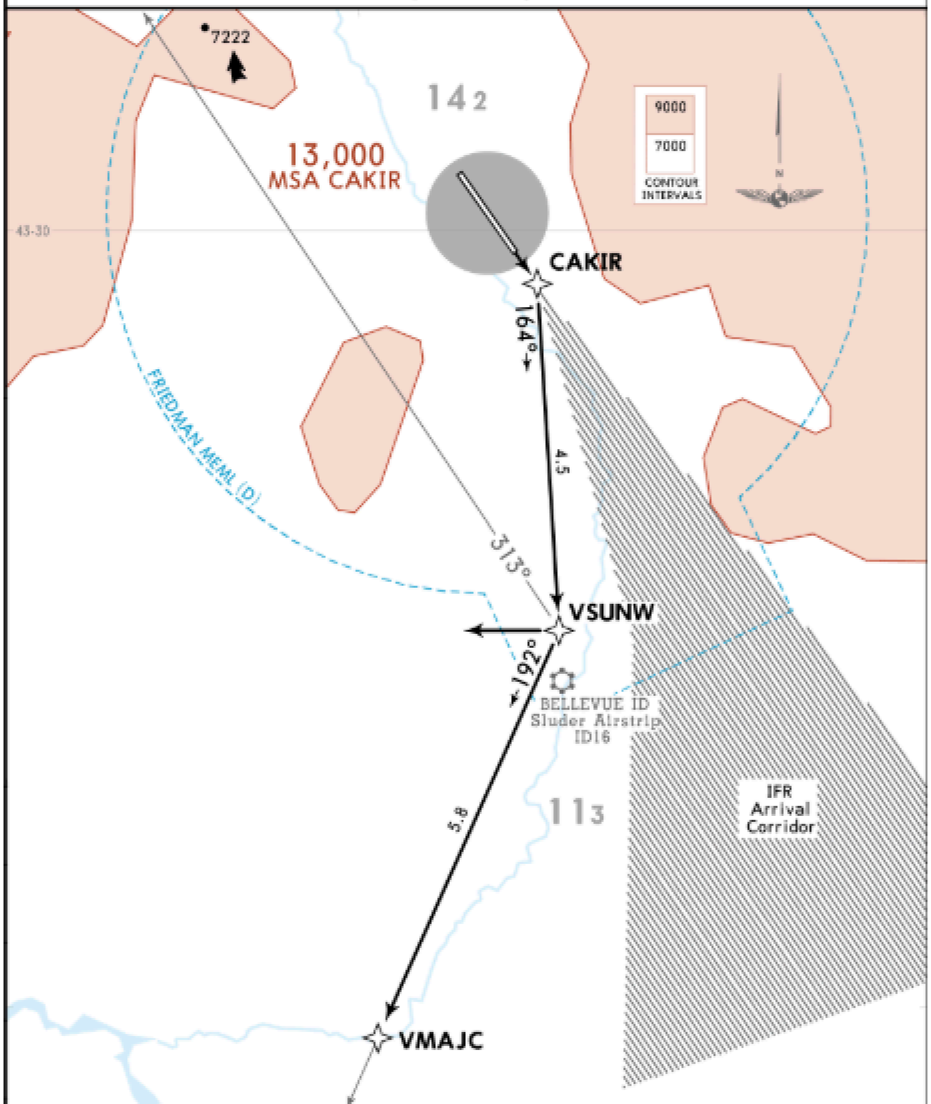
Appendix 2: Airport Terrain Environment



Appendix 3: WOOD RIVER VFR DEP

SALT LAKE Center (R) 118.05	Trans alt: 18000 1. OPPOSITE DIRECTION: Exercise extreme CAUTION EAST of Big Wood River, below 10500 MSL due to opposite direction arrivals. 2. DEFINITIONS: WEST side of the valley defined as, "WEST of the Big Wood River to depart the Class D airspace WEST of Sluder Airstrip". 3. PROCEDURE: Pilots should specifically request this procedure using the departure name. "WOOD RIVER 2 VFR DEPARTURE (KSUN)" 4. Pilots using this departure are required to adhere to all applicable Visual Flight Rules.
Apt Elev 5320	

WOOD RIVER 2 VFR DEPARTURE
(RWY 13)



INITIAL CLIMB

After departure fly direct CAKIR then direct VSUNW, if on-course is between 192° and 313°, proceed on course at your discretion; otherwise, direct to VMAJC, or at or above 10500 proceed on course.
OR
After departure fly runway heading for 0.5 NM beyond runway end, then turn RIGHT to approximate heading 163° until over Sluder Airstrip, if on-course is between 192° and 313°, proceed on course at your discretion; otherwise fly approximate heading 192° until SOUTH of Highway 20 or through 10500, then on course.